

Travel Portals vs Travel Agencies				
	Traveljini	Travnova	OutlookTraveller	Travel Agencies
International flight tickets	Rs 28,100 Mumbai-London-Mumbai (Gulf Air)	Does not offer discounted fares on air tickets	Rs 30,000 Mumbai-London-Mumbai (Emirates)	Rs 22,000 Mumbai-London-Mumbai
Hotel packages	Majorda Beach Resort Goa 3N/4D Rs 6,500 (per person)	Majorda Beach Resort Goa 3N/4D Rs 6,175 (per person)	Majorda Beach Resort Goa 3N/4D Rs 12,999 (per couple)	Majorda Beach Resort Goa 3N/4D Rs 9,333 (per couple)
Group tours (Domestic)	Kerala (luxury tour) 7N/8D Rs 17,835	Kerala tour 9N/10D Rs 29,850	No escorted tours	Kerala (luxury tour) 9N/10D Rs 25,575 (Kesari Tours)
Intenational group tours (hot deals)	Singapore Temptations Rs 25,999	South Africa Unveiled 7N/6D Rs 59,460	Vibrant Malaysia 6N/7D Rs 27,770	Singapore and Thailand Rs 21,990 + \$299 (Kesari Tours)

* Note: The prices for flight tickets are on a per person basis
**This table is only an indicative comparison of online travel rates. Do not forget to get online and check with the portal/travel agency for the full dope!

you to look up flight combinations and routes, both domestic and international, to any destination in the world in the airline of your choice. You'll get fares in Indian rupees for the route of your choice sorted by the class of travel. You can check **Makemytrip** for a quick flight search. However, not all sites will let you book a seat online. At **Traveljini**, you can look up seat availability for a flight but you'll have to e-mail in a booking request to block the seats. You pay for your ticket and can have it delivered to your doorstep. **Travnova**, on the other hand, lets you log on to Amadeus and block seats yourself, but only after divulging your credit card details.

Also look up the special offers and privileges which airlines offer. If you're flying British Airways (www.britishairways.com) or Singapore Airlines (www.singaporeair.com), you can now check-in online. Lufthansa has special offers if you book online directly with them, and lots of other airlines let you trace your baggage online.

In India, Jet Airways has a service called JetMobile which enables you to find out flight schedules, status and alerts through SMS. This service is available through cellular operators like Orange (Mumbai), Essar (Delhi), Spice/UMTL (Kolkata), Fascal (Gujarat), Tata Cellular (Andhra Pradesh) and Spice (Karnataka). Cathay Pacific and Singapore Airlines are other international airlines that offer this service in India.



Chugging along

The ubiquitous Indian Railways. Who can travel within

India without them? The best place to find out all about rail travel in India is, thankfully, the official Web site of the Indian railways itself at www.indrail.gov.in. This is a comprehensive site where you get almost all information you need about train travel—rail availability and options, train routes, seating availability, ticket status, and time of departure and arrival. You can't book or block seats online yet, but then, living in India, you'd know how to book a ticket offline. The Indian Railways has a wonderful 'Circular Trip' option wherein travellers can chart their own routes and get a connecting ticket from every station they stop at.

You can also buy international train passes when travelling outside India. For example, Eurail online passes are available on sites like **Traveljini**.



Taking the high road

If you're looking to rent a car for a road trip, you'll find plenty of models to choose from, and that too at decent rates. There are lots of sites online, and choosing a car is easy. Just pick the city, the car model and the rental period, and with an instant confirmation, you're on the road again.

In fact, most portals have an arrangement with local car rental agencies or travel agents in different cities; rates will differ according to the agency in the city concerned. **Traveljini** had different rates quoted by different travel agents in one city for the same car model! The important thing is that you can pick and choose the car you want—all from one place.

The rates aren't too bad and are comparable with what regular travel agents



Offers that Deserve a Closer Look

A good vacation can also cost you a bomb. But not if you're smart and have planned ahead. There are plenty of online deals that can save you a pretty penny—the idea is that you have to watch out for them. The thing with deals is that they keep changing depending on the season and the place.

Go to the 'deals' section of travel portals and airline Web sites regularly. Also, sign up for newsletters to keep up with the travelling world. Compare rates right down to the smallest detail, for example, service charges, before you clinch a deal. **Traveljini's** newsletter 'Deal-a-jini' brings

deals right into your inbox. If you don't mind waiting for the cheapest deal, try your luck at bidding for holiday packages in auction sites like **Baazee.com** and **Indiatimes.com**, which have packages from **Traveljini** and other agents. Place your bid and if you get lucky, you could end up winning a free holiday or air tickets at rock-bottom prices. There's one more way: simply pick a destination and state the price that you're willing to pay for a decent vacation. Then sit back and relax as various hotels come up and fight to deal with you. That's what reverse auctions can do. Check them out at **Traveljini**.